HILCHOT SHABBAT

Dyeing on Shabbat: Saffron, Sunbathing & Staining

Given Thursday 18 June 2026 · Hilchot Shabbat 320:18-20 — מלאכת צובע

Sefer: Shulchan Aruch · Orach Chaim **Siman:** 320 (ש"כ) **Topic:** מלאכת דש — Threshing & Squeezing (Completion) · מלאכת צובע — Dyeing **Tonight's Seifim:** 18 (the flax stopper · psik reisha d'lo nicha lei) · 19 (saffron — no dyeing in food) · 20 (colored fruit on a handkerchief) **Plus:** Squeezing hair · baby wipes · toothbrushes · contemporary Tzovei'a questions (sunbathing · toilet disinfectants)

Recap — The Structure of Siman 320

Part	Seifim	Content
1	א–ח	Mefarek/Sechita: squeezing fruit, lemons, pickles
2	ט–יד	Crushing ice and snow
3	טו–יז	Sechita of Melaben vs. Dash — towels, cotton, sponges
4 (tonight)	יח	The flax stopper — completing Dash/Melaben
(tonight)	יט–כ	**Melechet Tzovei'a** (dyeing)

The Two Sechitot (Established)

Melacha	What You Want
Dash (Mefarek)	The **liquid** being squeezed out (squeeze fruit/cloth to USE the liquid)
Melaben	The **item** — squeeze to REMOVE the liquid from a garment you want clean

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Seif 18 — The Flax Stopper (חבית שפקקה בפקק של פשתן)

The Text

חבית שפקקה בפקק של פשתן לסתום נקב שבדפנה שמוציאים בו היין, יש מי שמתיר (להסירו) ואף על פי שאי אפשר שלא יסחוט — והוא שלא יהיה תחתיו כלי, דכיון שאינו נהנה בסחיטה זו הוי פסיק רישא דלא ניחא ליה ומותר. וחלקו עליו ואמרו: אף על גב דלא ניחא ליה, כיון דפסיק רישא הוא — אסור.

The Case

A wine barrel sealed with a **flax/cotton stopper** in a hole in its wall. The stopper is **saturated with wine**. Removing it (and reinserting it — per Mishna Berura) **inevitably squeezes** wine out of it.

The Fundamental Machloket — Psik Reisha D'Lo Nicha Lei

Opinion	Ruling	Reasoning
The Aruch (early Rishon, 1000+ years ago)	**Permitted** (if no vessel underneath, so wine goes to waste)	A *psik reisha* in which you have **no benefit** (לא ניחא ליה) is permitted — even for a d'Oraita melacha — because Shabbat requires **מלאכת מחשבת** (purposeful, beneficial work)
Tosafot / majority	**Forbidden**	Even with no benefit, an inevitable consequence (psik reisha) is **assur** (at least d'Rabbanan)

The condition "no vessel underneath" (שלא יהיה תחתיו כלי) is critical. With a vessel collecting the wine, it's **נחא ליה** (beneficial) — real Dash, potentially d'Oraita. The whole discussion is only about wine going **to waste** on the floor.

The Classic Illustration

Washing your hands in a friend's garden: it's *Zoreia* (planting/watering) from the Torah, but you get no benefit — you just want clean hands, while inevitably watering the garden. **Aruch: permitted** (lo nicha lei, even d'Oraita). **Shulchan Aruch/majority: forbidden** (still assur, though not d'Oraita).

Three Principles Learned from This Seif

Principle 1 — There Is NO Libun With Other Liquids (אין ליבון בשאר משקין)

Since the wine here is **red wine**, why isn't pulling the stopper a problem of **Melaben** (cleansing the stopper of liquid)?

Because the Shulchan Aruch rules there is no Libun with liquids other than water. Squeezing wine out of a cloth doesn't "launder" it — it's still stained and smelly. The Rambam held there IS libun with other liquids; **the Shulchan Aruch rules against the Rambam.**

(Proof: if there were libun with wine, it wouldn't matter whether the wine goes to waste — pulling the stopper would inherently be Melaben. The fact that the Shulchan Aruch debates only the Dash/waste angle shows he holds no libun with wine.)

Principle 2 — Dash That Goes to Waste Is Still Dash D'Rabbanan

Even though the wine here (a) has no libun and (b) goes to waste, the Shulchan Aruch brings the main opinion that it's **still forbidden** — because **Dash performed where the liquid goes to waste is still assur d'Rabbanan.**

Principle 3 — Psik Reisha D'Lo Nicha Lei Is Assur (Not Like the Aruch)

The Shulchan Aruch rules mainly like the second opinion: **a psik reisha is forbidden even when you have no benefit** — not like the Aruch who permits it. *(Not d'Oraita, but still assur.)*

The Biur Halacha's Clarification (Rabbeinu Tam's Framework)

Two kinds of sechita:

- **Water from a garment → Melaben** (the water goes to waste; not Dash)
- **Other liquids (wine) →** the reverse: **no Melaben** (no cleansing) — the issue is only **Dash**, and only when you need the squeezed liquid

So with the wine barrel, the issue is **only Dash**; and since the wine goes to waste, **it falls outside Dash** for those who hold so. The entire seif is written **only according to the poskim who hold no libun with other liquids.** According to those who equate all liquids with water (especially wine), pulling the stopper would be **forbidden from the Torah** (Melaben).

The People's Lenient Practice (והעולם נוהגין היתר)

People are very lax — some even pull the stopper and **collect the wine in a vessel underneath** (which no one permits). The only justification (לימוד זכות):

The stopper has a **handle (בית אחיזה)** projecting out, so the hand doesn't touch the saturated part — **like a sponge with a handle** (Seif 17).

But this is a **weak argument** (יש בה גמגום), because unlike a sponge (where you only wipe with the surface), here you're **pulling the stopper out** and it squeezes. Therefore: **at minimum, ensure there is no vessel underneath** to collect the wine.

White Wine (Side Point)

The **Taz** (Rav David Segal) holds the Shulchan Aruch's leniency is **only for red wine**; **white wine has the status of water →** Melaben would apply. This is questionable (white wine still smells of wine — is squeezing it really "laundering"?).

Psik Reisha D'Lo Nicha Lei Everywhere ELSE in the Torah (Mishna Berura 53)

אבל חיובא ליכא בפסיק רישא דלא ניחא ליה לכולי עלמא everyone agrees there's no Torah liability — **אבל... שאר איסורי תורה — דעת הרא"ש דלא ניחא ליה לכולי עלמא אסור, ואיסורו מן התורה** *on Shabbat*

The whole leniency (or near-leniency) of psik reisha d'lo nicha lei is unique to Shabbat — because Shabbat requires *melechet machshevet* (purposeful work). **Everywhere else in the Torah, a psik reisha d'lo nicha lei is forbidden — and forbidden from the Torah.**

(Example: pouring wine on the Mizbe'ach inevitably extinguishes some of the fire — violating אש תמיד תוקד; even lo nicha lei, it's assur d'Oraita, because there's no melechet machshevet requirement outside Shabbat.)

Additional Dash Topics

Squeezing Hair

Water is **not fully absorbed** into hair — so squeezing hair isn't true Dash. **But it's assur d'Rabbanan** because the water amasses in the hair, resembling Dash. *(Universally agreed.)*

Drying Hair After a Shower/Mikvah

- **Majority of poskim**: Don't rub/squeeze the hair dry — **pat (dab) only** with the towel
- **Ben Ish Chai (surprisingly lenient here)**: Permitted to rub with a large towel —

1. It's **sechita k'le'achar yad** (an unusual manner of squeezing)
2. Squeezing hair is only **d'Rabbanan**
3. The water **goes to waste** (no Dash)

- **Rav Shlomo Zalman Auerbach** also lenient: it's two d'Rabbanans (waste + hair), and the water is **immediately absorbed into the towel** (not visible/usable) → permitted

Practical: Majority say pat only; there are opinions to rely on for rubbing with a towel.

Baby Wipes (Know the Metziut!)

Both **Rav Moshe Feinstein** and **Rav Shlomo Zalman** originally permitted baby wipes — but a student reports Rav Shlomo Zalman **retracted** at the end of his life.

Why the change? Modern wipes (Pampers, Huggies) hold **far more liquid** than the wipes of 40–50 years ago. Squeeze one today and significant liquid comes out. *(Rabbi Kada recalls Rav Falk z"l demonstrating this 20+ years ago in Gateshead.)*

The ruling:

- **Squeezing a baby wipe → assur d'Oraita** (real Dash/Mefarek — you use the extracted liquid)
- **Using the surface moisture only** (gently gliding, not pressing) → **permitted**

Toothbrushes

Densely packed bristles resemble hair → potential Dash concern.

- **Some poskim**: forbidden (hence Ashkenazi "Shabbat toothbrushes" with widely-spaced bristles → definitely permitted)
- **Chacham Ben Tzion Abba Shaul & others**: permitted — it has a **handle** (like the sponge with a handle), so it's not psik reisha
- **The halacha**: There's ample basis to **use a toothbrush with water on Shabbat**. (Toothpaste is more debatable — see the earlier shiur.)

PART 2 — Melechet Tzovei'a (Dyeing)

Background — Tzovei'a in the Mishkan

Dyeing was done in the Mishkan (the coverings and the rams' hides were dyed).

Tzovei'a vs. Writing

- **Writing (Kotev)**: putting text/marks on an underlying substance (paper)
- **Tzovei'a (Dyeing)**: **enhancing/coloring an existing thing** — "coloring in"

Deepening an existing color is also Tzovei'a d'Oraita. This is why **shoe polish on Shabbat is forbidden from the Torah** (among several melachot) — even though the shoe is already black, rubbing in more makes it darker/shinier = Tzovei'a. Likewise **makeup/lipstick** (intensifying the lip color) is Tzovei'a d'Rabbanan, even though it fades by the next day (אינו מתקיים → d'Rabbanan, not d'Oraita).

Seif 19 — Saffron in Food (No Dyeing in Food)

ליתן כרכום בתבשיל מותר, ואין לחוש משום צובע, דאין צביעה באוכלין *One may put saffron in a cooked dish; no concern of dyeing, because there is no dyeing with foods.*

The Universal Principle: אין צביעה באוכלין

Everyone agrees: there is no dyeing prohibition with foods. Two reasons (Rav Ben Tzion Abba Shaul):

1. **It's not the derech (normal way)** to dye food — so even when it happens, Chazal didn't forbid it
2. **Food is meant to be eaten** — all food eventually rots, so dyeing food can never be **מתקיים (permanent)**; since permanence is impossible, Chazal didn't forbid it

Application: Dipping bread into wine (reddening the bread) → **permitted** — ein tzevia ba'ochalin.

Is There Dyeing With LIQUIDS? (יש צביעה במשקין?)

The marquee case: adding **red wine to white wine** to color it.

Opinion	Ruling
Rambam & most Rishonim / Shulchan Aruch	**No dyeing with liquids** — permitted
The Yere'im (Rabbi Eliezer of Metz)	**There IS dyeing with liquids** (יש צביעה במשקין) — because the *essence* of Tzovei'a is making **paint**, which is itself a liquid

The Halacha

וכן מותר ליתן יין אדום בתוך יין לבן אף שמתאדם one may add red wine to white wine even though it reddens (Mishna Berura)

- **Chacham Ovadia**: Permitted outright — even Mishna Berura holds mikar hadin it's permitted
- **Even the stringent view** permits it **with a small shinui**: since paint is normally made by putting water first then adding dye, **reverse the order** — put a little red wine in the cup *first*, then pour the white wine. Everyone permits this.

- **Ben Ish Chai (machmir)**: Requires the shinui — always add the color-base first, then the liquid (e.g., making Ribena/squash: water first, then concentrate → reverse it)

Intentionally Coloring Food or Drink

ואפילו אם מכוון לכתחילה לעשות מראה... גם כן מסתבר דאין להחמיר (Mishna Berura)

Examples:

- **Pesach**: adding red wine to white wine to fulfill the inyan of red wine at the Seder (recalling the blood)
- **A child's yogurt**: adding food coloring to make it purple so the baby will eat it

Opinion	Ruling
Mishna Berura / Biur Halacha / Chacham Ovadia / majority	**Permitted** even when intentionally coloring (food OR drink)
Nishmat Adam / Chayei Adam / Kitzur (Gantzfried)	Wanted to forbid when done intentionally

Bottom line: permitted even if your intent is to make it colorful.

Where Coloring IS Forbidden

ומכל מקום אין רשאי לעשות מראה ביין ודבש שיקנו ממנו — וכל שכן שלא לשים סממנים בצלוחית מים להעמיד בחלון נגד השמש, דחייב חטאת

1. **Commercial purpose** (coloring wine/honey to sell it) → **forbidden**
2. **Coloring a NON-edible liquid** (e.g., dye drops in a decorative bowl of water for display) → **forbidden, possibly d'Oraita (chayav chatat)**

Key clarification: *Ein tzevia b'mashkin* applies only to liquids **you will drink**. Water for display/decoration is not "mashkin" in this sense. Likewise children's craft pasta that's dyed and dried to last → that's not edible-in-practice → **forbidden**.

Seif 20 — Colored Fruit and the Handkerchief

יש מי שאומר שאוכל תותים או שאר פירות צבועין צריך להזהר שלא יגע בידיו הצבועות בבגדיו או במפה משום צובע. אבל אם צובע פיתו במשקה הפירות — לית לן בה, דאין צביעה באוכלין.

The Case

Eating strawberries / beetroot / mango → your hands are stained red/purple/yellow. **One should be careful not to wipe the colored hands on clothing or a napkin** (because of Tzovei'a). *(Dipping bread in the fruit juice is fine — ein tzevia ba'ochalin.)*

Why This Should Actually Be Permitted — Several Layers

Layer 1 — Psik Reisha D'Lo Nicha Lei B'Issur D'Rabbanan

- Drying your hands inevitably colors the cloth → **psik reisha**
- You have **no benefit** — you want clean hands, you're *dirtying* the cloth → **lo nicha lei**
- The coloring is **not permanent** → **d'Rabbanan**
- **Psik reisha d'lo nicha lei on a d'Rabbanan = permitted**

Layer 2 — "צריך להזהר" Means Caution, Not Prohibition (Chacham Ovadia / Chida) The Shulchan Aruch wrote *tzarich lizaher* ("one should be careful") — which, per the **Chida (Machzik Beracha)**, means a **commendable caution, NOT a prohibition.** Mikar hadin it's permitted; he recorded it only because the **Yere'im** said it.

Layer 3 — The Radbaz: צביעה דרך לכלוך (Coloring in a Dirty Manner) Rabbi David ben Zimra: This isn't Tzovei'a at all. The essence of Tzovei'a is **precise, enhancing, artful coloring** — done to *beautify*. Here you're **dirtying** a cloth while cleaning your hands, with no harmony or precision (a bit of red here, purple there). **Coloring in a dirty manner is simply not the melacha of Tzovei'a. → Permitted.**

Red vs. White Handkerchief

Posek	View
Magen Avraham	A **red** handkerchief is *worse* — you lose the Radbaz's "dirtying" sevara (you're not dirtying a red cloth)
Eliya Rabba	A red handkerchief is *better* — red-on-red isn't really coloring anything

The Halacha

- **Mishna Berura**: Rely on the Radbaz **where it's difficult** (eating outside, no tap/tissues nearby); but mikar hadin be strict with a white handkerchief
- **Chacham Ovadia**: Mikar hadin **permitted** — it's psik reisha d'lo nicha lei (only a zehirut) AND tzevia derech lichluch (Radbaz's strong sevara). **המחמיר תבוא עליו ברכה**, but it's fully permitted to wipe colored hands on a white (or red) handkerchief

Disposable Tissues — Permitted by All (Shulchan Aruch HaRav)

Even if one is strict, the prohibition would only apply to a **reusable** cloth (handkerchief, tablecloth). **Disposable tissues are permitted by everyone.**

Proof (Ba'al HaTanya): A woman's **bedikah cloth** — checking for blood inevitably "colors" the cloth. How is this permitted? Because the bedikah cloth is **disposable** — no Tzovei'a concern. So anything disposable is fine.

Practical hierarchy: Tissues (best) → handkerchief → water → (last resort) wipe on arm/leg.

PART 3 — Contemporary Tzovei'a Questions

Question 1 — Sunbathing / Tanning on Shabbat

The case: Intentionally sitting in the sun on Shabbat afternoon to get a tan (not merely incidentally while reading).

The Minchat Yitzchak (Rabbi Yitzchak Weiss, Manchester Av Beit Din, ~60 yrs ago) — FORBIDS

Five reasons, each difficult:

#	Argument	The Counter
1	**Refuah** (medicine) on Shabbat	But **דרך בריאים** — things normal healthy people do are permitted; everyone does this
2	**Tzovei'a** (dyeing your skin)	See the grama response below
3	**Causing oneself pain**	Valid — if you suffer in the sun for the tan, that's against *oneg Shabbat* → wrong
4	**Hashash of using creams** (memareiach)	Just be careful not to spread creams in a forbidden way
5	**Uvda d'chol** (weekday activity)	Vague catch-all

Chacham Ovadia (and Rav Shlomo Zalman) — PERMIT

- On the Tzovei'a argument: **it's grama (indirect)** — coloring normally happens immediately when you paint; here it takes hours. → permitted
- Rav Shlomo Zalman: **you're completely passive** — just sitting back while it happens by itself; how can that be a melacha?

(Counter-thought: just as planting (Zoreia) is not called grama even though the seed sprouts days later — because that's the nature of the melacha — one could argue tanning's slowness is also the nature of Tzovei'a (vat-dyeing took time). The response: vat-dyeing was one form, but the tzura of the melacha is immediate coloring.)

Ruling: Mikar hadin **permitted** to sunbathe/tan on Shabbat — provided it's enjoyable (not painful) and creams aren't applied in a forbidden manner. *(Moot for those whose skin doesn't tan.)*

Question 2 — Toilet Disinfectants / Colored Hygiene Blocks

In the Cistern (back tank) → PERMITTED by all

Flushing sends water out; new water enters and gets colored by the block.

- It's a **psik reisha** (you flush to remove waste; coloring is inevitable)
- AND it's **psik reisha b'grama** — the coloring happens gradually (seconds/half a minute to collect)
- **Psik reisha b'grama is permitted by all** → no problem leaving a cistern disinfectant in on Shabbat

In the Bowl itself → MORE QUESTIONABLE (homework for next week)

Flushing colors the water in the bowl. Can't use *ein tzevia b'mashkin* (this isn't a drinkable liquid). So why might it be permitted (or forbidden)?

Rabbi Kada left this as an open question to think through using the principles learned — and what to do if one already left it in (may one still flush?). To be resolved at the start of next week's shiur, then on to Melechet Tochein.

Summary of Tonight's Halachot

Seif 18 — The Flax Stopper

- **The Aruch**: psik reisha d'lo nicha lei is permitted (even d'Oraita); **Shulchan Aruch/majority: forbidden**
- Three principles: **(1)** no Libun with liquids other than water; **(2)** Dash that goes to waste is still d'Rabbanan; **(3)** psik reisha d'lo nicha lei is assur
- Psik reisha d'lo nicha lei is lenient **only on Shabbat** (melechet machshevet); **everywhere else it's assur d'Oraita**
- Squeezing hair (pat, don't rub — though there's room to be lenient); baby wipes (surface only, never squeeze); toothbrush with water (permitted)

Seifim 19–20 — Tzovei'a

Topic	Ruling
Saffron / dyeing food	**Permitted** — אין צביעה באוכלין (universal)
Red wine into white wine (liquid)	Permitted (Shulchan Aruch); even stringent view permits with reversed order; Ben Ish Chai requires the shinui
Intentionally coloring food/drink	Permitted (majority) — Pesach wine, child's yogurt
Commercial / non-edible liquid coloring	**Forbidden** (possibly d'Oraita)
Colored hands on a handkerchief	Mikar hadin **permitted** (psik reisha d'lo nicha lei + Radbaz's tzevia derech lichluch); disposable tissues permitted by all
Sunbathing/tanning	**Permitted** (grama; passive) — if enjoyable, creams used properly
Toilet disinfectant in cistern	**Permitted** (psik reisha b'grama)
Toilet disinfectant in bowl	Open question — next week

Coming Up Next Week

- Resolving the toilet-bowl disinfectant question (and what to do if left in)
- Beginning **Melechet Tochein** (grinding) and subsequent melachot

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B'Ezrat Hashem — Siman 320 Complete

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